Okoye Laboratory: Quarterly Report, April to June 2026

Summary

Negative controls were run with every batch; none showed growth, and the blanks read within the usual range. Incubator B was checked before the run and showed no drift against the reference. The autoclave was checked before the run and showed no drift against the reference. Plates were incubated at 30 °C for 24 h before counting, and each count was made by two people. Plates were incubated at 37 °C for 36 h before counting, and each count was made by two people.

Colony counts were entered into the shared sheet the same day, with the plate identifiers written as on the lids. The pH meter was checked before the run and showed no drift against the reference. All media were autoclaved and poured in G.12, and the plates were dried for 34 minutes in the cabinet.

The compost came from three sites, and each site was sampled at 8 points along a transect. Tom prepared 19 replicates of corn meal agar and logged the lot numbers in the notebook. Samples were thawed on ice, vortexed for 37 s, and spun at 5570 g for 5 minutes. The leaf litter came from three sites, and each site was sampled at 6 points along a transect.

Samples were thawed on ice, vortexed for 16 s, and spun at 6222 g for 11 minutes. Cultures were inspected daily under the dissecting microscope, and any plate with a foreign colony was discarded. All media were autoclaved and poured in G.14, and the plates were dried for 16 minutes in the cabinet. All media were autoclaved and poured in G.16, and the plates were dried for 20 minutes in the cabinet.

Plates were incubated at 25 °C for 96 h before counting, and each count was made by two people. The leaf litter was sieved through a 2 mm mesh, homogenised, and stored at 4 °C until the extraction. Incubator A was checked before the run and showed no drift against the reference. Imani repeated the assay on a second day to check that the result did not depend on the batch of medium. The pellet was resuspended in 482 µL of sterile water and transferred to a clean tube.

The department asked for the equipment inventory to be updated; Marcus has the spreadsheet. Visitors to the prep room must sign the book and be accompanied at all times. The cold room in G.12 will be defrosted over the weekend, so nothing should be left on the floor shelves. Hana will order the potato dextrose broth and the pipette tips for next month, and asked everyone to put requests in the sheet by Friday.

A reminder that all new strains need an accession number from Hana before they go into the freezer. The booking sheet for the autoclave was reorganised so that overnight runs are marked clearly. Dr. Okoye will cover the weekend checks of the autoclave until the end of the month. Training on the new plate reader is arranged for the first week of the month; Dr. Okoye will run it.

Sven will order the Czapek agar and the pipette tips for next month, and asked everyone to put

requests in the sheet by Friday. Training on the new plate reader is arranged for the first week of the month; Dr. Okoye will run it. Hana reminded the group that waste from G.16 goes into the yellow bins and sharps into the rigid containers.

Finance

Consumables spending in the second quarter was £14,206.50, which is 8% under budget. Equipment repairs came to £1,930.00, mostly for the plate reader's lamp.

A reminder that all new strains need an accession number from Tom before they go into the freezer. Visitors to G.14 must sign the book and be accompanied at all times. Hana reminded the group that waste from the prep room goes into the yellow bins and sharps into the rigid containers. A reminder that all new strains need an accession number from Marcus before they go into the freezer. Marcus will cover the weekend checks of the autoclave until the end of the month.

The booking sheet for the autoclave was reorganised so that overnight runs are marked clearly. The booking sheet for the centrifuge was reorganised so that overnight runs are marked clearly. The cold room in G.12 will be defrosted over the weekend, so nothing should be left on the floor shelves.

Dr. Okoye will cover the weekend checks of Incubator B until the end of the month. Training on the new plate reader is arranged for the first week of the month; Imani will run it. The shared fridge in the prep room was cleared out, and anything unlabelled was thrown away. Hana will cover the weekend checks of the centrifuge until the end of the month.

Research progress

The pellet was resuspended in 456 µL of sterile water and transferred to a clean tube. Cultures were inspected daily under the dissecting microscope, and any plate with a foreign colony was discarded. Tom repeated the assay on a second day to check that the result did not depend on the batch of medium. The beech litter came from three sites, and each site was sampled at 6 points along a transect. Marcus repeated the assay on a second day to check that the result did not depend on the batch of medium.

Incubator B was checked before the run and showed no drift against the reference. The compost came from three sites, and each site was sampled at 4 points along a transect. Tom repeated the assay on a second day to check that the result did not depend on the batch of medium. Marcus prepared 7 replicates of Czapek agar and logged the lot numbers in the notebook.

Marcus prepared 8 replicates of Czapek agar and logged the lot numbers in the notebook. Imani prepared 9 replicates of corn meal agar and logged the lot numbers in the notebook. Plates were incubated at 25 °C for 36 h before counting, and each count was made by two people. Cultures were inspected daily under the dissecting microscope, and any plate with a foreign colony was discarded. All media were autoclaved and poured in G.14, and the plates were dried for 39 minutes in the cabinet.

Samples were thawed on ice, vortexed for 50 s, and spun at 4146 g for 4 minutes. Negative controls were run with every batch; none showed growth, and the blanks read within the usual range. All media were autoclaved and poured in the cold room, and the plates were dried for 18 minutes in the cabinet. Negative controls were run with every batch; none showed growth, and the blanks read within the usual range.

A 10-fold dilution series to 10^-6 was plated in triplicate on potato dextrose agar. Absorbance was read at 600 nm after shaking for 6 seconds, and blanks were subtracted before analysis. Hana repeated the assay on a second day to check that the result did not depend on the batch of medium. The pellet was resuspended in 357 µL of sterile water and transferred to a clean tube. Hana repeated the assay on a second day to check that the result did not depend on the batch of medium.

The root washings was sieved through a 2 mm mesh, homogenised, and stored at 4 °C until the extraction. Imani repeated the assay on a second day to check that the result did not depend on the batch of medium. Plates were incubated at 22 °C for 96 h before counting, and each count was made by two people. Absorbance was read at 600 nm after shaking for 27 seconds, and blanks were subtracted before analysis.

Samples were thawed on ice, vortexed for 19 s, and spun at 3817 g for 9 minutes. Samples were thawed on ice, vortexed for 18 s, and spun at 3551 g for 4 minutes. Hana prepared 11 replicates of potato dextrose broth and logged the lot numbers in the notebook. Plates were incubated at 28 °C for 24 h before counting, and each count was made by two people. The peat was sieved through a 2 mm mesh, homogenised, and stored at 4 °C until the extraction.

The leaf litter was sieved through a 2 mm mesh, homogenised, and stored at 4 °C until the extraction. Colony counts were entered into the shared sheet the same day, with the plate identifiers written as on the lids. All media were autoclaved and poured in the cold room, and the plates were dried for 44 minutes in the cabinet.

Samples were thawed on ice, vortexed for 39 s, and spun at 10368 g for 5 minutes. A 10-fold dilution series to 10^-6 was plated in triplicate on potato dextrose agar. The forest soil was sieved through a 2 mm mesh, homogenised, and stored at 4 °C until the extraction. The beech litter came from three sites, and each site was sampled at 9 points along a transect.

Equipment and incidents

The ultra-low freezer in room G.12 failed on 5 June and 214 samples were moved to the freezer in room G.14 within 40 minutes. No samples were lost. A replacement compressor was fitted on 12 June.

The booking sheet for Incubator B was reorganised so that overnight runs are marked clearly. The department asked for the equipment inventory to be updated; Tom has the spreadsheet. The department asked for the equipment inventory to be updated; Hana has the spreadsheet.

The shared fridge in G.14 was cleared out, and anything unlabelled was thrown away. The booking sheet for the pH meter was reorganised so that overnight runs are marked clearly. A reminder that

all new strains need an accession number from Hana before they go into the freezer.

The shared fridge in the prep room was cleared out, and anything unlabelled was thrown away. Visitors to G.12 must sign the book and be accompanied at all times. Dr. Okoye will cover the weekend checks of the pH meter until the end of the month.

Plans for the third quarter

Visitors to the cold room must sign the book and be accompanied at all times. Tom will order the corn meal agar and the pipette tips for next month, and asked everyone to put requests in the sheet by Friday. Sven reminded the group that waste from the prep room goes into the yellow bins and sharps into the rigid containers. Tom reminded the group that waste from G.16 goes into the yellow bins and sharps into the rigid containers.

The shared fridge in the cold room was cleared out, and anything unlabelled was thrown away. Visitors to G.10 must sign the book and be accompanied at all times. Training on the new plate reader is arranged for the first week of the month; Priya will run it. The department asked for the equipment inventory to be updated; Tom has the spreadsheet.

The department asked for the equipment inventory to be updated; Imani has the spreadsheet. The cold room in G.10 will be defrosted over the weekend, so nothing should be left on the floor shelves. The shared fridge in the cold room was cleared out, and anything unlabelled was thrown away. Training on the new plate reader is arranged for the first week of the month; Priya will run it. The booking sheet for the plate reader was reorganised so that overnight runs are marked clearly.